

County Council Meeting July 28th, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=UXsU8o2udJs
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Delaware County Council Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: July 28, 2026

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding Officer Mr. Hughes called the regular meeting of the Delaware County Council to order on July 28, 2026 [00:04:13](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - *Members Present:* Mr. Langan, Mr. Whead (Whited), Mr. Mogle (Mole), Mr. Bookout, Ms. Piper, Mr. Kues (Can/Kz), and Mr. Hughes (President).
 - *Members Absent:* None noted.
 - *Presiding Officer:* Mr. Hughes.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The council held a moment of silence in remembrance of former council member Mel Bodkin, who passed away on July 3rd at the age of 22 [00:04:17](#). This was followed by the Pledge of Allegiance led by Ben [00:04:40](#).
- **Approval of Minutes:** The council voted to table the approval of the June 23rd meeting minutes due to administrative technical issues, including a 10-day outage in their AI

application and lack of access to the employee portal [00:12:04](#). Passed by roll call vote.

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- [00:06:06](#) **Resolution 2026-07: Midwest Metal Products Personal Property Tax Abatement**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Gina Carvalia (Economic Development Alliance) alongside Brad (Tax Abatement Committee) and Chad Smith (CEO, Midwest Metal Products).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Midwest Metal Products sought a standard 5-year personal property tax abatement for a new state-of-the-art metal laser cutter valued at approximately \$1.4 million. The tax abatement committee issued a favorable recommendation. Because the equipment is in a TIF district, the redevelopment commission captures the revenue rather than the county general fund.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Mr. Whead abstained due to a spouse's employment with the company; all other voting members approved).
- [00:13:15](#) **Bulk Health, Vision, and Dental Insurance Transfers (County General)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council / Auditor's Office.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfers moving appropriations from health insurance accounts (-\$154,528.76 across accounts) to cover vision (+\$23,644.64) and dental (+\$130,884.12) insurance lines, which were not fully covered at budget time. Total transfer equals zero.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
- [00:16:28](#) **Bulk Insurance Transfers (Outside County General)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council / Auditor's Office.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Similar insurance adjustments for funds outside County General: Health insurance (-\$30,834.08), Vision insurance (+\$5,901.12), and Dental insurance (+\$25,643.96). Total transfer equals zero.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
- [00:17:47](#) **Emergency Management Agency (EMA) Salary Transfer**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Cory Kessick, EMA Director [00:18:11](#).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer of \$4,800 from the deputy director line (102) to the director line (101) to cover the remainder of the director's salary for the year following a payout, while leaving enough funds in the deputy line for a future hire.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
- [00:19:12](#) **Council Health Insurance Transfer**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer of \$3,000 to health insurance and \$200/\$169 to vision/dental, offset by a \$4,000 reduction in professional services, to cover health

insurance for a council member not budgeted last fall.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Ms. Piper abstained).
 - **00:20:04 Prosecutor's Office Transcription Fee Transfer**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Lisa Carr, Prosecutor's Office [00:20:16](#).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer of \$5,000 from transcription fees to professional services (used for third-party transcripts) to cover a larger-than-expected \$10,000 transcription bill.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
 - **00:21:54 Plan Commission Benefit Line Adjustments**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Kylene Swackmer, Plan Commission [00:22:37](#).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Adjustments across various benefit lines (vision, dental, short-term disability, PERF, life insurance, long-term disability) funded by overages in the health insurance line.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Mr. Whead and Mr. Kues voted "no").
 - **00:25:25 High-Tech Crime Unit Supplies Transfer**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Lisa Carr (on behalf of Chuck Zimmers), Prosecutor's Office [00:25:49](#).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer of \$1,900 for office supplies, \$1,000 for software repairs/maintenance, and \$900 for education/schooling to stock up on bulk supplies (backup tapes, etc.).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
 - **00:26:40 County Highway Benefit & Insurance Adjustments**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Kerry, County Highway [00:27:48](#).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Adjustments to align benefit lines and resolve discrepancies where funds were not properly pulled from specific administrative/field sub-accounts (10,000s, 20,000s, 30,000s).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
 - **00:31:24 Communications Gifts & Donations Appropriation**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Fred [00:31:44](#).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Replenishing donation lines and equipment maintenance accounts (\$1,070.60) for dispatcher week purchases (backpacks, mugs) initially paid out of an incorrect line.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
 - **00:33:37 Assessor's Office Contractual Services Appropriation**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Sher Chaffen, Chief Deputy Assessor [00:33:48](#).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer of \$10,474 into contractual services from the sales disclosure fund to cover Form 11 postage, printing, and programming (\$52,151 total spent year-to-date on notices).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:24:36 Rick Yans** (Newsman and Author): Addressed the council regarding the nickel-and-dime nature of local government appropriations, warned about potential issues and costs associated with implementing AI for non-emergency public safety calls, and expressed community frustration regarding rising taxes, vehicle registration fees, and recent reassessments.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements & Appointments:**
 - **Backfilling Report:** Received and approved a report featuring only one backfilled employee **00:36:18**.
 - **Job Descriptions:** Approved four updated job descriptions recommended by the job classification committee (EMA Executive Director and Office Manager; Auditor's Office Accounting Administrator and Project/Compliance Leader) **00:46:05**.
 - **Municipal Unit Strategic Task Force (MUST):** Appointed Matt Kues as the council's representative to oversee local income tax law changes and coordinate with municipal financial officers ahead of an October 1st state reporting deadline **00:50:50**.
 - **Civic Center Authority:** Noted two upcoming vacancies (one Democrat, one Republican) for terms beginning August 1st through July 31, 2028; the council will post the opening and seek local attorneys interested in applying **00:54:26**.
 - **One-Touch Initiative Advisory Committee:** Suspended rules to immediately appoint Mike Ashley (and later noting Gary's participation) to the internal committee overseeing time-clock software modernization **01:01:19**.
 - **911 AI Non-Emergency Call Handling:** Fred announced a proposed 3-year contract (\$85,000/year) with an AI provider for non-emergency dispatch calls, to be funded via the statewide 911 fund without impacting County General **01:14:11**.
 - **Upcoming Meetings:** Special meeting scheduled for Tuesday, August 18, 2026, at 9:00 a.m. for revenue projections and presentations from Policy Analytics and Baker Tilly; regular meeting on August 25, 2026; budget hearings to begin Wednesday, September 9, 2026 **01:28:01**.
- **Adjournment:** Official motion to adjourn made by Jessica, seconded by Dan, and passed by roll call vote **01:28:52**.